

Tackling bullying

Bullying can seem like a difficult situation to resolve, but it's important to take action, as everybody will suffer if it continues.

If you're being bullied

- Try not to react to the bully in the way they anticipate or get angry, as they may lose interest.
- Block bullies online or on your phone and keep any abusive messages as a record.
- Tell a trusted adult what is happening, or contact a support group if you feel you can't talk to your parents or teacher.

If you're trying to help someone who is being bullied

- Don't watch or join in with the bullying, as this may encourage the bullies.
- Stand up for the person as long as you feel it is safe to do so.
- Advise the person being bullied to tell, or help them to tell, an adult they trust. Tell an adult yourself if they are unable to.

If you're the bully

- Apologize to the people you have bullied and try to make amends.
- Ask a trusted adult to help you resolve any difficult feelings or situations you might be struggling with.
- Forgive yourself, learn from your behavior, and move on.

If you're the parent of a bully

- Bullies often resort to bullying because they feel insecure, fearful, or unable to cope. Sometimes they're being bullied themselves. Try to find out why they've behaved in this way.
- Encourage your teen to apologize and to try to make amends.
- Help your teen to see that how they behaved is not who they are as a person.

Impact of bullying

Being bullied can affect every aspect of a young person's life. It can disrupt their ability to sleep, enjoy activities, or study, and have an impact on their physical health. Their mental health might suffer as bullying can lead to low self-esteem, anxiety, feelings of anger or aggression, and depression.

PARENT TIPS

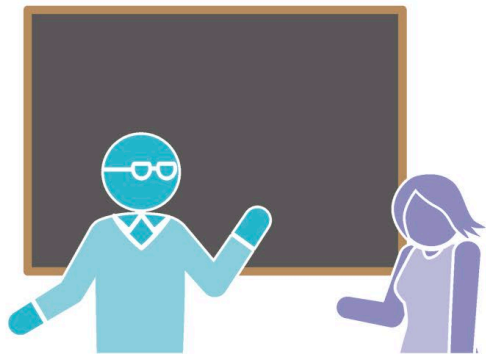
Seeing the signs

It can be hard to know if your teen is being bullied, as they may not want to tell you. The following signs may indicate a problem:

- sudden reluctance to do activities they previously enjoyed
- unexplained changes in behavior, such as becoming withdrawn or preoccupied
- coming home with bruises or without certain belongings
- anxiety about going to school or complaining about feeling too ill to go to school when they are well

Getting help

A teen may find it difficult to admit they are being bullied, but acknowledging the problem is the first step toward resolving it. It's important for a teen to call on their friends for emotional support, and to talk to a trusted adult who can take action to improve the situation.



△ Opening up

If a young person feels in physical danger or if the situation has spun out of control, telling the school, or even the police, might be appropriate.